

Zersh Salman

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Education

Lahore University of Management Sciences (LUMS)

Sep 2018 – May 2023

BS – Computer Science (Senior Thesis: CBT Through Gamification for High School Students)

- Relevant Coursework: Human Computer Interaction, Information Communication Technologies for Development, Cognition and Computers, Education for Social Justice, Computational Problem Solving

Experience

Adam Smith International | REMIT Program (FCDO-funded)

Feb 2025 – Present

Associate Consultant – Service Designer

Nov 2025 - Present

- Conducted extensive desk research and system analysis of existing FBR portals used by taxpayers and tax officers to identify structural and workflow inefficiencies.
- Led primary research with tax officers, including in-depth interviews and shadowing sessions, to understand real-world operational workflows and pain points.
- Facilitated knowledge-transfer sessions with subject-matter experts and senior tax officials to document tax laws, procedures, and institutional practices.
- Collaborated with a multidisciplinary team to design, test, and iterate key modules of the proposed FBR Tax Collector Portal.

Associate Consultant – UX Strategist

Feb 2025 – Oct 2025

- Contributed to the design and refinement of the Simplified Income Tax Return service, focused on reducing complexity, simplifying legal language, and improving ease of filing for millions of taxpayers.
- Produced comprehensive design specifications to support accurate implementation of the Simplified Return across development teams.
- Worked closely with FBR and PRAL developers, performing UX and UI QA, logging functional and visual issues, and overseeing implementation to ensure design fidelity.
- Conducted an in-depth UX and content audit of the existing FBR website, identifying critical usability, accessibility, and information-architecture issues.
- Led the redesign of the FBR public website, delivering a modern, citizen-centric digital platform that improves how individuals and businesses interact with tax services nationwide.

Trazmo | Early-stage fintech startup

Aug 2024 – Jan 2025

Founding Product Designer

- Founding product designer responsible for designing and prototyping the entire MVP for a Sharia-compliant, AI-enabled lending platform.
- Defined core product strategy and feature set, helping position the startup in a competitive fintech and Islamic finance landscape.
- Designed end-to-end lending workflows, including risk-assessment engines, credit scoring models, approvals, and monitoring systems.
- Led the creation and design of investor and stakeholder pitchdecks, clearly articulating product vision, differentiation, and technical depth.
- Contributed directly to the Startup's successful acceptance into Spring Studios (Startup accelerator in Bahrain - Nov 2024) and selection into Nvidia's Inception Program (June 2025).

Loop Financial Services | Fintech startup

Sep 2023 – July 2024

Associate UI/UX Designer

- Sole product designer responsible for end-to-end UX and product design for the company's open banking and SME financing platform.
- Collaborated closely with a cross-functional team of 7 engineers (frontend, backend, QA) to ensure accurate and scalable implementation.
- Designed core open-banking modules including payments, financing, virtual accounts, sweeps, reconciliation, etc.
- Presented product designs to various banks, NBFCs, and delivery partners, adapting design narratives for technical, business, and regulatory audiences.

Phoenix Design

Jun 2022 – Apr 2023

UI/UX Design Intern

- Led end-to-end design delivery for multiple client engagements, spanning research, UX strategy, prototyping, UI design, and content structuring.
- Delivered high-fidelity prototypes and design documentation, supporting smooth handoff and implementation.

Lahore University of Management Sciences

Aug 2020 – Dec 2020

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant

- Served as a teaching assistant for an undergraduate Writing and Communication course, supporting a cohort of 28 students.
- Conducted regular office hours and tutorial sessions providing structured feedback on academic writing, argumentation, and clarity.
- Evaluated and graded all written assignments, ensuring fairness and constructive feedback.

Research Projects

EthnoLearn: Understanding and Practice of Ethnographic Research

Jan 2023 – April 2023

Advisor: Dr. Maryam Mustafa

Working as project lead, analysed university students' perceptions of research in Pakistan, and investigated the impact of teaching ethnography as a pedagogical intervention to enhance their research skills.

Mindways: CBT Through Gamification for High School Students

Sep 2022 – May 2023

Advisor: Dr. Suleman Shahid

Developed a Unity-powered 3D game in partnership with The City School, designed to improve student mental health through gamified Cognitive Behavioral Therapy.

TaskKing: Micro Tasking App for Low Literate Users

Sep 2021 – Nov 2021

Advisor: Dr. Suleman Shahid

Designed and proposed digital experiences for low-literate users and socially restricted women in Pakistan, enabling remote income opportunities via feature phones and entry-level smartphones

Service

Teaching Fellow

Sep 2025 - Oct 2025

Al-Bayan School System

Languages

- Urdu - Native
- English - Fluent

Soft Skills

Programming languages: C++, Python

Design Software: Figma, Miro, Mural, Canva

Prototyping: Justinmind, Protopie

Project Management: Notion, Linear, Slack

Video Editing: Premiere Pro, Davinci Resolve, After Effects

Positions of Responsibility

Vice Captain

Jul 2021 – Apr 2022

LUMS Boxing Team

Led bootcamps and training sessions, mentored junior members, and organized inter-college competitions.

Director Events

Jul 2021 – Apr 2022

LUMS Women in Computing (LWiC)

Organized and planned both external and internal events for LWiC and its collaborative organizations.

Hobbies and Interests

Endurance sports (running and cycling), tennis, sketching, leadership development, continuous learning